

HTML5 Cheat Sheet

Semantic structure, forms, media & accessibility — the core tags you'll actually use, in one quick-revision page.

Semantic HTML

Forms

Media

Accessibility

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1 Document Skeleton

```
<!-- every HTML5 page starts here -->
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html lang="en">
  <head>
    <meta charset="UTF-8">
    <meta name="viewport" content="width=device-width, initial-scale=1.0">
    <title>Page Title</title>
  </head>
  <body>
    <!-- visible content goes here -->
  </body>
</html>
```

2 Semantic Layout Tags

 **<header> / <footer>**
Top intro/branding and bottom closing content of a page or section.

 **<main>**
The one unique, central content of the page (use once per page).

 **<article>**
Self-contained, independently distributable content (a post, a card).

 **<nav>**
Wraps the site's primary navigation links.

 **<section>**
A thematic grouping of content, usually with its own heading.

 **<aside>**
Tangential content — sidebars, pull-quotes, related links.

3 Text & Content Tags

<h1>—<h6> **<p>** **<a href>** **** **** ** / / ** **
** **<hr>** **<blockquote>** **** **<div>** **<table>/<tr>/<td>**

4 Forms & Inputs

Tag / Type	Use it for
<code><form action="" method="post"></code>	Wraps all form fields; sends data on submit
<code>input type="text"</code>	Single-line free text
<code>input type="email" / "password"</code>	Built-in format validation
<code>input type="checkbox" / "radio"</code>	Multi-select / single-select choices
<code>input type="date" / "file" / "number"</code>	Native date picker, file upload, numeric stepper
<code><select><option></code>	Dropdown list of choices
<code><textarea></code>	Multi-line text input
<code><label for="id"></code>	Accessible caption — always pair with an input id
<code><button type="submit"></code>	Submits the form

5 Media & Embedding

 ****
Always include **alt** text — for SEO and screen readers.

 **<audio controls>**
Same pattern as video — built-in player, no JS needed.

 **<video controls>**
Add `<source src="" type="">` inside for multiple formats.

 **<iframe src>**
Embeds another page (maps, YouTube videos, widgets).

6 Useful Global & Data Attributes

 **Accessibility tip:** use one `<h1>` per page, meaningful `alt` text, real `<button>` / `<a>` tags instead of clickable `<div>` s, and `aria-label` when an element has no visible text.

7 Head Essentials & Linking Files

SEO basics

- `<meta name="description" content="...">`
- `<meta property="og:title" content="...">` for link previews

Linking files

- `<link rel="stylesheet" href="style.css">`
- `<link rel="icon" href="favicon.ico">`
- `<script src="app.js" defer></script>`

8 Quick Lists & Tables Example

```
<!-- unordered list -->
<ul>
  <li>HTML</li>
  <li>CSS</li>
</ul>
```

```
<!-- simple table -->
<table>
  <tr><th>Skill</th></tr>
  <tr><td>HTML5</td></tr>
</table>
```

9 Common Character Entities

< → <

> → >

& → &

© → ©

 → space

" → "